Agreement will live upto its expectations or not. Never-the-less the UN Secretary-General Ban Ki-Moon called it a “monumental success for the planet and its people”. A safe and green planet needs to be ensured for our future generations and for this climate change issue needs to be addressed on an emergency basis. Unfortunately, the entire effort got a jolt when the US refused to sign the Paris accord and decided to withdraw from it in 2017. However, France, Germany Italy, Japan, Canada and United Kingdom proclaimed that the Paris agreement is irreversible and its full integrity will contribute to the security and prosperity of the planet, societies and economies. It becomes clear that it is a tough battle that has to be fought amidst oddities to secure the Earth for our future generations.

COP24 was held in 2018 at Katowice, Poland. A comprehensive “rule book” was created to specify the details of the guidelines towards the implementation of Paris Agreement. The new Special Report on Global Warming of 15°C by Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) received lukewarm response regarding cutting of carbon emission by 2020. Negotiations got strained over issues like climate finance and differentiation of responsibilities among developed and developing countries. One achievement was the signing of the “Solidarity and Just Transition Silesia Declaration” to tackle the transition towards low carbon economy which is sure to face stiff social resistance on the home turf of the countries trying to implement global climate policy.

The United Nations Climate Change Conferece, the COP 25 took place in Madrid, Spain from 2 December to 13 December, 2019 under the Presidency of Chile (there was a change of venue of the conference due to inability expressed by Chile to host the conference). There was no major breakthrough as negotiations got fraughted and no consensus could be reached regarding Article 6 pertaining to rules for carbon market requiring transparency and common timeframes for climate pledges. This was stalled till 2020. Disappointment with COP 25 was expressed by UN Secretary General António Guterres as a lost opportunity to show increased ambition on mitigation, adaptation and finance to tackle climate change issue.